

Noise Master Buds 2

Do they stand out in a competitive market?

Every time I get an affordable or mid-range pair of earbuds, I am curious how they stand out. The titular Noise Master Buds 2, launched at an introductory price tag of Rs 7,999, featuring Sound by Bose tuning, LHDC high-res audio support, adaptive ANC rated up to 51dB, spatial audio with head tracking and a distinct design. Well, the predecessor, the Master Buds, also has many of these features and specs. However, some differences are very obvious right away, and during my review time, I wanted to see how well they come together in actual use. Let's see if they hold up to the ambitious Master tag.

A DISTINCTIVE CASE AND COMFORTABLE EARBUDS

Our review unit's Carbon (black/dark grey) colour with the metal paint finish offers a sophisticated look. You can also pick them in Mercury (silver) and Aurum (golden) colours.

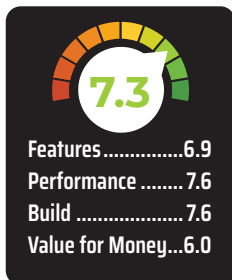
On the front, there is a circular metal disc with an LED strip positioned at 1 o'clock. That LED tells you the active, charging and pairing state. The disc isn't mechanical and doesn't offer any functional value. It is just there for a look, which is the signature of Noise's Master series.

The case is made out of plastic but feels decently solid. It can be slid into jeans or a jacket pocket, but there will be a slight bulge.

Opening the lid reveals the earbuds sitting neatly in their slots. The hinge feels sturdy, and the magnets hold the earbuds securely while charging.

The earbuds themselves follow a familiar stem-style in-ear design.

₹7,999



They are lightweight, weighing around 5.2 grams each, which makes them comfortable for extended listening sessions. Noise includes interchangeable silicone ear tips and ear wings in the box. After trying a couple of combina-

tions, I settled on a fit that felt secure enough for use in the office, metro, and home. However, the ear wings tend to slip out of position over time. When that happens, the earbuds lose their secure fit and do not sit properly in the ears. It also makes placing them back into the case slightly inconvenient, as they do not align easily with the charging cavities. Because of this, the ear wings feel like a hassle at times.

Still and all, when they stayed put in my ears, I could continue wearing them for hours without noticeable fatigue. So, good points for that. And like the predecessor, these are also IPX5 water-resistant. So, they can withstand heavy rain, splashes, and sweat. Just don't submerge them in water.

DECENT CONNECTIVITY AND CONTROLS WITH SOME QUIRKS

Pairing the Noise Master Buds 2 is straightforward thanks to Google Fast Pair support. When you open the case near an Android phone, a prompt appears automatically to connect the earbuds. This makes the initial setup quick and convenient. By the way, I also didn't have any problem connecting it to my MacBook and iPhone.

Speaking of which, thanks to dual-device connectivity, I could easily switch between all these devices. But the audio handoff or routing doesn't always work as intended. Occasionally, audio would wrongly play from one of these devices' speakers instead of the earbuds.

The earbuds also paused audio or video on their own a few times, without any input from me. Not sure why.

The Noise earbuds also support in-ear detection. This did work as expected, though. You have to enable this in the companion app. Another feature that has to be manually enabled is Motion Control.

The Noise Audio app is central to managing many of these features. Through the app, you can toggle ANC modes, adjust the equaliser, enable spatial audio, configure touch gestures, and locate misplaced earbuds using the Find My Device feature.

The app interface looks modern and is fairly simple and easy to navigate. The built-in AI assistant worked well in my test. I only asked about the weather conditions and what to wear. It answered promptly and was actively responding to my follow-up queries. Moreover, you can anytime call the device assistant like Gemini and get responses through that. Sweet!

CLEAR VOCALS, CLEAN TUNING

The Noise Master Buds 2 use a custom 10mm dynamic driver made from a PU and PEEK composite material. According to the company, this combi-